



Course Syllabus

Principles of Economics (ECO 2305-001)

Fall 2025

Instructor: James Kemper, MSFE, Ch.E.

Office: Holden Hall 243

Office Hours: MW 10 am – 11:30 am and by appointment

Class Time and Location: MWF 9:00 am – 9:50 in Holden Hall 150

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Required Material

- “*Essentials of Economics*” by Glenn Hubbard and Anthony O'Brien. This is a Texas Tech University custom eBook edition from Pearson Higher Education, including an access code to Pearson's MyEconLab.
- It is important to follow the instructions on Canvas before using Pearson's access code. These instructions will be available on Canvas.
- Class notes

Course Description

This is an abridged course for students not majoring in economics. It covers the most significant portions of Principles of Microeconomics (ECO 2301) and Principles of Macroeconomics (ECO 2302), with an emphasis on monetary and fiscal policy.

Course Purpose

This course satisfies the Texas Tech University core curriculum requirement in social and behavioral sciences. The objective of the social and behavioral sciences in a core curriculum is to increase the students' knowledge of how social and behavioral scientists discover, describe, and explain the behaviors and interactions among individuals, groups, institutions, events, and ideas. Such knowledge will better equip students to understand themselves and the roles they

play in addressing the issues facing humanity. This course is also a required course for all lower-division undergraduate students in the Rawls College of Business.

Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

This course satisfies the university core curriculum requirement in social and behavioral sciences: "Students graduating from Texas Tech University should be able to demonstrate the ability to assess critical claims about social issues, human behavior, and diversity in human experiences. This course meets the following Texas Tech University's general student learning outcome for social and behavioral sciences in that students will be able to:

- **Identify** and **critique** alternative explanations for claims about social issues and human behavior.
- **Demonstrate knowledge** of the appropriate ethical methods, technologies, and data that social and behavioral scientists use to investigate the human condition.

There are four main objectives to the core curriculum requirements that this course satisfies:

- **Critical Thinking Skills:** to include creative thinking, innovation, inquiry, and analysis, evaluation and synthesis of information;
- **Communication Skills:** to include effective development, interpretation and expression of ideas through written, oral and visual communication;
- **Empirical and Quantitative Skills:** to include the manipulation and analysis of numerical data or observable facts resulting in informed conclusions; and
- **Social Responsibility:** to include intercultural competence, knowledge of civic responsibility, and the ability to engage effectively in regional and national communities.

More specifically, for this course, students should be able to:

- Explain the concepts of demand, supply, and market equilibrium and their applications.
- Compare and contrast various market structures and the behavior of firms
- Understand various macroeconomic measures—GDP, unemployment, and inflation.
- Understand factors attributing to long-run economic growth, productivity and living standards.
- Understand the role of the government and the Federal Reserve Bank in combating short-run economic problems, such as recessions, high unemployment, and high inflation.

Grading and Evaluation

Quizzes

From time to time, there will be quizzes. Your instructor will discuss specific details with you. The quiz grade will represent 10% of the final grade. The lowest quiz grade will be dropped from your final quiz grade average.

MyEconLab Homework

There will be weekly homework assignments on Pearson's MyEconLab. The homework will consist of multiple-choice and true/false questions. The instructor will discuss specific details

with you during class. The homework grade will represent 20% of your final grade. The lowest HW grade will drop from your final homework grade average.

Exams

There will be four midterm exams, including a Final Departmental Exam. Each midterm exam will include 30 to 40 multiple-choice questions. Exam dates are listed below.

The midterm exams are weighted for students' benefit. Of the four midterm exams, your lowest grade weighs 10%, your second lowest grade weighs 15%, your second highest exam grade weighs 20%, and your highest midterm exam grade weighs 25% of your final grade. Thus, the four midterm exams weigh 70% of your final grade.

Examination Calendar

First Exam: Friday, 9/19
Second Exam: Friday, 10/10
Third Exam: Friday, 11/7
Final Exam: Monday, 12/8, 4:30 pm - 7:00 pm

The Departmental Makeup Exam will be on Wednesday, 11/19, from 5-7 pm in Holden Hall 76.

Grading Scale

A = 90% - 100%
B = 80% - 89%
C = 70% - 79%
D = 60% - 69%
F = less than 60%

Grade Distribution

Assignment	Weight
Quizzes	10%
MyEconLab HW	20%
Highest Midterm Exam	25%
2nd Highest Midterm Exam	20%
3rd Highest Midterm Exam	15%
Lowest Midterm Exam	10%
Total	100%

You can access a grade calculator by scanning the QR below or clicking this [link](#).



Recitation and Instruction Sessions

The Department of Economics offers supplemental instruction sessions for ECO 2305 to enhance student learning and success. **These optional review sessions will begin in the second week of classes and will be held on Wednesdays from 6:00 to 7:00 PM in Holden Hall 77.**

Course Requirements

1. Per university policy, attendance in all face-to-face and synchronous core curriculum courses with synchronous meeting times. Attendance will be recorded using aPlus+ Attendance (please see below for more information). Incidents of excessive absence will be addressed consistently with university policy and procedures.
2. Students are expected to have their IDs with them in class. The instructor reserves the right to ask a student to show his/her ID, especially during exams.
3. Any cheating will result in an (F) for the course. The instructor reserves the right to investigate further.
4. You will be given a grade of zero for any test you miss until you replace it with the grade of the makeup exam.
5. Students who show up 10 minutes or more after the start of an exam will not be permitted to take it.

Texas Tech University Policies

Texas Tech Policies Concerning Academic Honesty, Special Accommodations for Students with Disabilities, Student Absences for Observance of Religious Holy Days, and Accommodations for Pregnant Students can be found by clicking the link below:

<https://www.depts.ttu.edu/tlpdc/RequiredSyllabusStatements.php>

Required Attendance Tracking for Core Curriculum Courses

Faculty are required to track attendance in all face-to-face and synchronous core curriculum courses with synchronous meeting times.

Attendance and participation are important to help you learn the course material and connect with me and your peers. In this course, we will use aPlus+ Attendance to track attendance. This is integrated with RaiderCanvas. You are responsible for checking your attendance weekly in Grades in your RaiderCanvas course to make sure that your participation has been counted. Requests for changes must be made in writing to the instructor or TA within the week after the class and before the next class.

Statement on the Use of Artificial Intelligence (AI)

The use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT) is not permitted in this course; therefore, any use of AI tools for work in this class may be considered a violation of Texas Tech's Academic Integrity policy and the Student Code of Conduct since the work is not your own. Using unauthorized AI tools will result in a referral to the Office of Student Conduct.

Tentative Course Outline (Instructors may or may not finish all chapters below)

ECO 2305: Principles of Macroeconomics Tentative Course Outline Fall 2025

Week	Dates			Topics	Assignments*
Week 1	8/25	-	8/31	Ch 1: Economics Foundations	
Week 2	9/1	-	9/7	Ch 2: Trade-Offs and Comparative Advantage	HW Ch 1 & 2
Week 3	9/8	-	9/14	Ch 3: Where do Prices Come From? (Demand and Supply)	HW Ch 3
Week 4	9/15	-	9/21	Review and 1st Midterm Exam	Midterm 1
Week 5	9/22	-	9/28	Ch 4: Market Efficiency and Market Failure	HW Ch 4
Week 6	9/29	-	10/5	Ch 7: Consumer Choice and Elasticity	HW Ch 7
Week 7	10/6	-	10/12	Review and 2nd Midterm Exam	Midterm 2
Week 8	10/13	-	10/19	Ch 12: GDP	HW Ch 12
Week 9	10/20	-	10/26	Ch 13: Unemployment and Inflation	
Week 10	10/27	-	11/2	Ch 13: Unemployment and Inflation (continued)	HW Ch 13
Week 11	11/3	-	11/9	Review and 3rd Midterm Exam	Midterm 3
Week 12	11/10	-	11/16	Ch 15: Aggregate Demand and Aggregate Supply	HW Ch 15
Week 13	11/17	-	11/23	Ch 16 and 17: Money, Banks, and the Fed	HW Ch 16 & 17
Weeks 14 & 15	11/24	-	12/3	Summary, revision, and preparation for Final Exam	Final Exam 12/8 4:30 pm - 7 pm

***Assignments are due on Sundays at 11:59 PM CST unless noted.**